

ADR 0049 — V1 scope freeze: eighteen never-started issues closed as won't-do, M6/M7 retired, M8 deleted

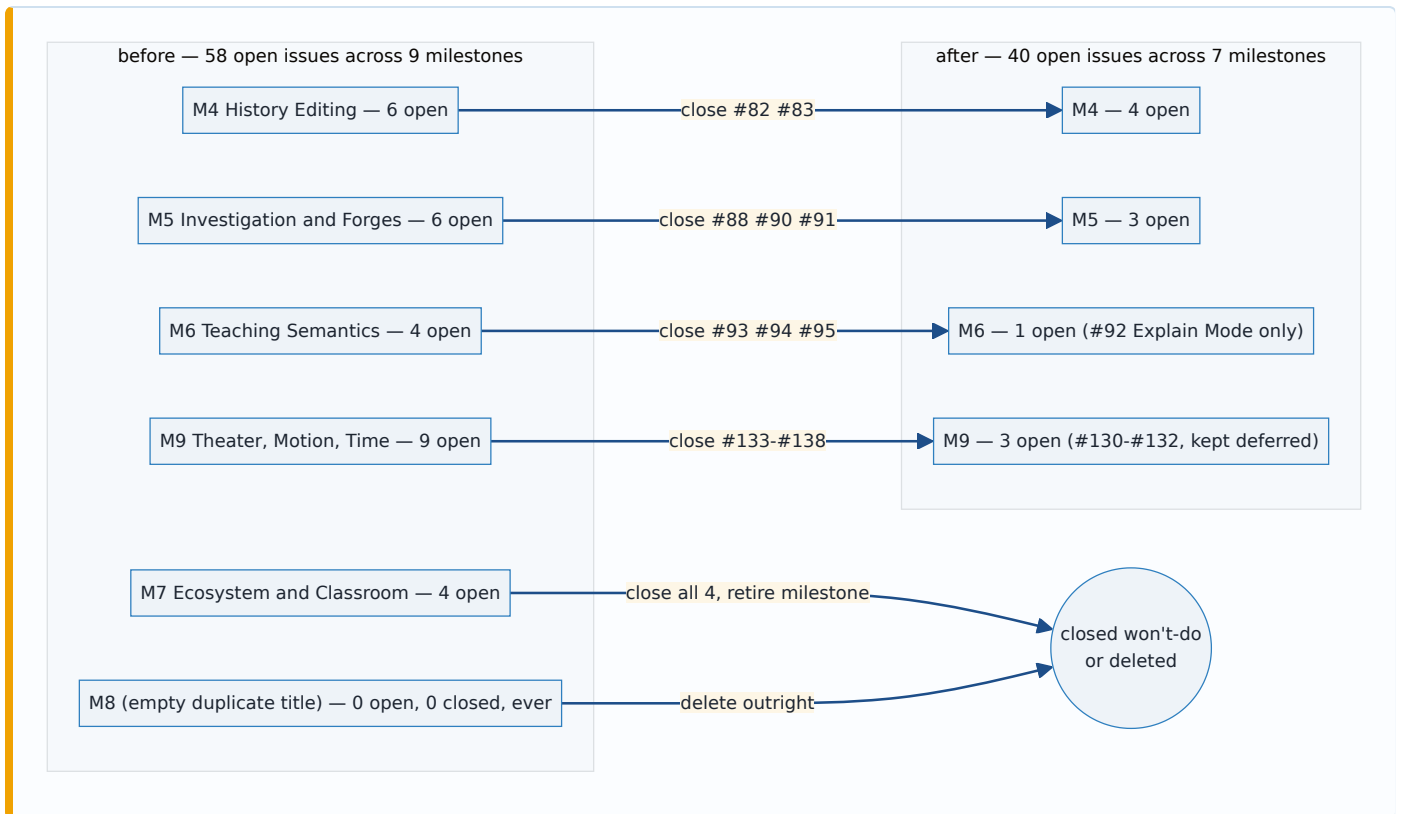
- **Status:** Accepted — tracker changes only; no code or protocol touched.
- **Date:** 2026-08-05.
- **Milestone / issue:** None (a tracker-hygiene decision, not a shipped slice). Applies to eighteen issues across M4, M5, M6, M7 and M9; retires milestones M6 and M7; deletes the empty duplicate milestone M8.
- **Supersedes / superseded by:** Nothing.
- **Related:** [0031](#) (why the alternatives table below exists). Every issue named in this ADR keeps its own text as the record of what it originally proposed — this ADR records only the freeze decision and the return condition, not a rewrite of eighteen issue bodies.

Context

Git-Vista is a solo-owned, personal project. As of this freeze the tracker holds **58 open issues** (55 attached to a milestone, plus three — #218, #308, #316 — that carry none and are untouched by this ADR) spread across nine milestones, M1 through M9. Two of those milestones (M6, M7) had never shipped a single issue, a third (M8) had never held one at all, and a fourth (M9) was nine-tenths speculative: only its first three phases (#130–#132) had a stated, current reason to exist.

A backlog sized like that stops being a plan and starts being a claim the tracker makes about the future that nobody is actually working toward. Every open issue reads, to a later session or a later collaborator, as "this is coming" — M7's `M7.43 – M7.46` numbering alone implies four sequenced steps toward an ecosystem-and-classroom future that no one has touched since the issues were filed. That is a cost independent of whether any individual idea was good: it is honesty debt on the roadmap, and `./dev roadmap` inherits it every time it prints a milestone list.

An opus-model sequencing pass was run over the full open backlog to find issues that (a) have zero implementation — no branch, no PR, no partial code — and (b) sit in a product direction the owner does not currently intend to build. That pass proposed 18 cuts. Each one was re-verified in this session, live, before this ADR was written: `gh issue view` against all 18 (title, state, milestone, and full body — not just the title, per this project's standing rule that confident citation of unread content has burned it six times before), a text search of every other open issue's body for a reference to each cut number (to catch orphaned dependents before closing anything), and a branch/PR search across the whole repository for any of the 18 numbers (none found — the "never-started" claim is not asserted, it is demonstrated absent).



Decision

1. Closing is not deleting

Every issue below is closed with the label/state `won't-do`, not deleted. It stays readable at its permanent URL, keeps its full history and comment thread, and can be reopened by anyone with write access at any time — there is no ceremony required beyond reopening it and, ideally, noting what changed. Each closing comment states the specific condition under which it would return (see the table in §2), so "reopen" is never a bare guess about what the owner would need to see. This is the whole point of the amnesty framing: cutting scope should cost nothing to reverse, because the only thing it removes is the tracker's claim that work is imminent, not the idea itself.

2. The eighteen closures, grouped by cut and with a concrete return condition each

All 18 were re-verified live this session (title + full body via `gh issue view`, dependency search across every other open issue, branch/PR search across the repo). None has a branch, a PR, or partial code. Every `why_cut` below is this session's own finding, not a transcription of the owner's rationale.

M7 — retired whole milestone. All four M7 issues close; none of M7 survives.

#	Title	Why cut	Return condition
#96	M7.43 Design an Out-of-Process Extension Protocol	Its own acceptance criteria require that “at least two existing adapters fit without privileged escape hatches”, and V1 ships at most one adapter (#89, GitHub) — the issue's own two-adapter precondition cannot be met.	A second real adapter ships beyond #89, making its own two-adapter precondition meetable, and a third party wants to extend without a source change.
#97	M7.44 Design Classroom Mode as a Separate Service	Multi-tenant instructor/student service with its own identity/authorization/retention model — a different product with a different threat model. Depended on M6.40 / M6.41 , also cut here.	A concrete classroom use case appears with someone willing to own the separate-service security model.
#98	M7.45 Research Paired HTTPS LAN Mode	The SSH tunnel already serves the personal LAN/iPad access need; this was research into an alternative with its own certificate/DNS-rebinding threat surface.	SSH tunneling proves insufficient for an actual access need.
#99	M7.46 Evaluate Optional Local Snapshot Synchronization	Its own acceptance criteria required "a clear, validated user problem" before implementation — none ever appeared. Depended on M6.42 (#95), also cut.	A concrete, validated cross-device workflow need appears.

M6 teaching product — three of four close; #92 Explain Mode is kept untouched.

#	Title	Why cut	Return condition
#93	M6.40 Build an Isolated Git Simulator Backend	Foundational backend for the teaching-product line; the whole direction is cut except Explain Mode, which works against real production plans and never needed a simulator.	A concrete teaching/classroom use case returns needing isolated, disposable repos.
#94	M6.41 Ship Merge-Conflict and Rebase Trainers	Downstream of #93 (cut). The shared conflict/rebase machinery it would have reused (#84, #85) stays for the real app.	Reopens together with #93 if a validated classroom need returns.
#95	M6.42 Export Printable and Shareable Redacted Diagrams	Handout/presentation export built for the teaching line; the export/redaction feature has no validated need outside teaching use.	A concrete non-classroom need for exporting/redacting diagrams appears.

Forge abstraction and non-GitHub adapters — three close; #89 GitHub PR integration is kept, re-scoped to absorb what it needs from #88.

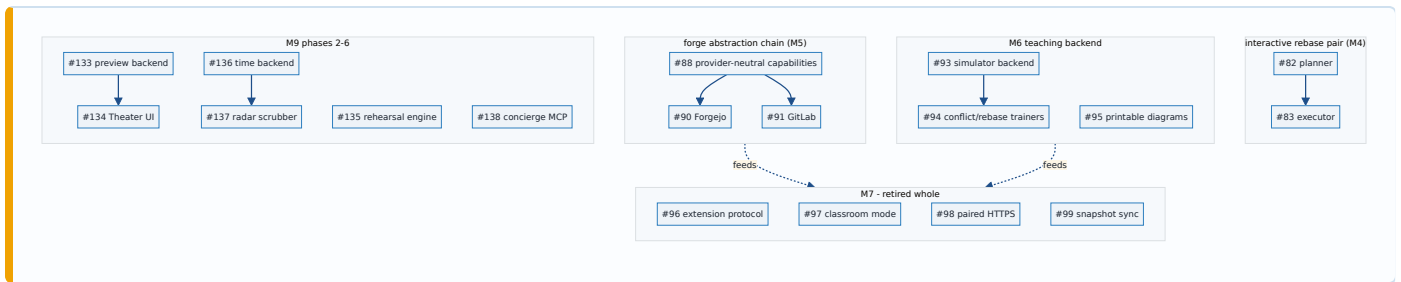
#	Title	Why cut	Return condition
#88	M5.35 Define Provider-Neutral Forge Capabilities	V1 stays GitHub-only; a provider-neutral capability layer designed ahead of a second real provider tends to guess the seams wrong.	A second forge provider (Forgejo, GitLab) is actually being built — two real implementations to abstract over instead of one plus a guess.
#90	M5.37 Add Read-Only Forgejo Change-Request Integration	Depends on #88, also cut. No adapter code exists.	A specific Forgejo user need appears, after #88's capability boundary is rebuilt for a real second provider.
#91	M5.38 Add GitLab Merge Request Integration	Depends on M5.35 and M5.37 (#88, #90), both cut, plus M5.36 (#89, kept). Never started.	A concrete GitLab request arrives post-V1, once a forge-neutral boundary (if any) has actually shipped.

M9 phases 2-6 (Operations Theater / time reconstruction) — six close; #130-#132 (fleet, journal snapshots, stable graph identity) are kept as deferred foundation.

#	Title	Why cut	Return condition
#133	M9.04 Candidate futures backend (<code>POST /api/preview</code>)	Never-started phase 2 of the Theater vision; a consumer of the M9.01-03 foundation, not a prerequisite for it.	#130-#132 ship and there is a concrete, current design need for operation preview — not just because the foundation exists.
#134	M9.05 Operations Theater UI	Phase 3 UI, depends on #133 (cut).	#133 returns first and ships, and there is a live product reason to build the swipeable-cards UI on top of it.
#135	M9.06 Rehearsal engine (scratch-clone execute-for-real)	Phase 4, never started.	A genuine revival of #133/#134 with a concrete case for rehearse-before-apply that V1's direct-execute model doesn't already cover.
#136	M9.07 Time reconstruction backend + as-of viewer	Phase 5, ships standalone per its own description but never begun.	A concrete need for as-of/time-travel viewing of history arrives post-V1, independent of the rest of M9 Theater.
#137	M9.08 Radar-loop scrubber	Phase 6 UI, "Consumes M9.07" (#136, cut).	#136 returns first and ships, and finger-driven scrubbing remains wanted.
#138	M9.09 Concierge MCP (schedule-driven fleet)	Own body flags it "personal-only, horizon item... requires its own brainstorm + design doc" — the lowest-commitment item in the whole cut set. Requires #130 (kept, deferred) as prerequisite.	#130 ships and there is an actual desire to automate fleet scheduling — needs a fresh design pass regardless.

Interactive rebase — both close; #84 shared conflict resolution and #85 force-with-lease are kept, since the real app needs them independent of interactive rebase.

#	Title	Why cut	Return condition
#82	M4.29 Touch-First Interactive Rebase Planner	Never-started XL planner UI (drag-to-reorder pick/reword/squash/fixup/drop).	Interactive rebase becomes a stated V-next priority; returns together with #83.
#83	M4.30 Execute and Recover Interactive Rebases	Never-started XL execution engine, depends directly on #82 (cut).	Returns together with #82; #84/#85 stay in place as the infrastructure it would build on.



3. M7 retired; M6 shrinks to its lone survivor

M7 ("Future: Ecosystem & Classroom") had four open issues and zero closed ones; all four close in this freeze, so nothing remains under it. It is **closed as a milestone on GitHub** (milestones have an open/closed state and closing is reversible; its title and description stay as the historical record of what it once proposed) and is no longer referenced by `./dev roadmap`'s active-milestone framing.

M6 ("Teaching Professional Semantics") keeps exactly one open issue after this freeze: [#92](#) Explain Mode, explicitly kept. **Execution instruction: M6 stays OPEN, holding only #92.** A one-issue milestone is an honest shape — it says exactly what survives of the teaching direction. Whether [#92](#) should later be re-homed to a milestone that better reflects "one shipped teaching feature, not a teaching *product*" is left for a future, separate call; closing M6 with [#92](#) still inside it would make the issue invisible to milestone-filtered views, which is the lie-class this tracker cleanup exists to remove.

4. M8: deleted outright, not closed with a return condition

M8 carries the **same descriptive title** as M7, differing only in the milestone-number prefix ("M7 — Future: Ecosystem & Classroom" / "M8 — Future: Ecosystem & Classroom") and has zero issues attached — not zero *open* issues, zero *ever*: `open_issues: 0, closed_issues: 0`. It is a duplicate milestone shell with no history to preserve, which is why it is deleted rather than retired alongside M7: the amnesty (§1) exists to preserve a record of a real proposal that is being deferred, and M8 never held one.

5. What is explicitly not touched

None of the following are in any close list in this ADR, and none should be inferred as affected by it: everything in M2 and M3, [#92](#) (Explain Mode), [#89](#) (GitHub PR integration, kept and re-scoped to absorb what it needs from [#88](#)), [#84/#85](#) (shared conflict resolution, force-with-lease), [#130/#131/#132](#) (M9 fleet/journal/graph-identity foundation, kept as deferred), [#238](#), [#80/#81/#86/#87](#), and [#141](#). Also untouched: the three open issues with no milestone at all ([#218](#), [#308](#), [#316](#)) — this freeze only reasons about milestone-attached backlog.

6. Two kept issues carry a stale dependency line

Two KEPT issues declare dependencies on issues this freeze closes, and neither blocks it:

- [#89](#) (kept) says "Depends on: M5.35" — that is [#88](#), cut. Non-blocking because [#89](#) is explicitly re-scoped to absorb the parts of [#88](#) it actually needs, with GitHub types allowed at the handler boundary.
- [#85](#) (kept) says "Depends on: M2.20, M4.29" — M4.29 is [#82](#), cut. Non-blocking because [#85](#)'s own Goal needs force-with-lease after amend, which shipped in M2.19/M2.20 independent of any interactive-rebase work.

Both issue bodies need their "Depends on" lines edited to match; that follow-up is part of executing this ADR, not a separate decision.

Alternatives considered

Alternative	Why it lost
Keep everything open	The status quo the freeze exists to fix: 58 open issues across nine milestones, most never started, reads as a roadmap the tracker cannot honestly back. A solo owner gains nothing from a backlog that outlives its own credibility, and every session that touches <code>./dev roadmap</code> inherits the confusion of what's actually intended.
Cut more (e.g. close #92 , #89 , #84/#85 , or M3 wholesale)	Rejected per the owner's explicit KEPT list. Each of those has either shipped adjacent infrastructure it depends on (#84/#85 for the real conflict/force-push workflows), is actively re-scoped rather than abandoned (#89 absorbing #88), or is a deliberately-deferred-not-cut foundation (#130-#132). Cutting them would remove work the owner still wants, which is a different decision than clearing dead scope.
Milestones-only (retire M6/M7/M9 as milestones, leave every individual issue open and unlabeled)	Leaves the dishonesty at the issue level even after fixing it at the milestone level — an open, unlabeled #96 still reads as "planned" to anyone who filters by label instead of milestone. The tracker's per-issue state is what <code>gh issue list --state open</code> and most tooling actually reads; milestone-only cleanup would look done and not be.
Delete the 18 issues instead of closing won't-do	Deletion destroys the record and the return condition along with it — the next person (or the owner, eighteen months later) who wonders "did we ever consider Forgejo support" finds nothing instead of a closed issue with a dated, specific answer. Closing preserves exactly what deletion would erase, at zero ongoing cost.
Retire M8 with a return condition like the issues, instead of deleting it	M8 never held an issue, open or closed — there is no proposal, no history, and no reasoning to preserve. Treating it like the 18 substantive cuts would manufacture ceremony around an empty shell that was very likely a milestone created twice by mistake.

Consequences

- The tracker now shows **40 open issues across 7 active milestones** (M1, M2, M3, M4, M5, M6, M9 — M7 gone, M8 deleted), plus the two pre-existing unmilestoned issues (#232, #316) this freeze does not touch. `./dev roadmap` reflects this the next time it is run; no code change is needed for that, since it reads milestones/issues live from GitHub.
- Reopening any of the 18 is a normal GitHub reopen plus removing/updating the `won't-do` state — no special process, no re-filing, no lost text. The closing comment on each issue states the specific return condition, so a future reopener does not have to re-derive intent from a title.
- M6 is now a one-issue milestone (#92 only). This ADR does not resolve whether that milestone should be renamed, folded, or left as-is; flagged here so it isn't rediscovered as a surprise later (§3).
- M8's deletion is irreversible in the sense that a deleted milestone cannot be "reopened" the way a closed issue can — but since it never held any issue, there is nothing to lose. If "Future: Ecosystem & Classroom" work is ever revived, it revives under M7 (retired, not deleted, title and description intact) or a fresh milestone, not under a resurrected M8.
- Nothing here changes `docs/SECURITY_MODEL.md` — no security boundary moved, no code shipped or removed. This is a tracker-state decision exclusively.
- The dependency verification performed for this ADR (live issue bodies, cross-reference search, branch/PR search) found no orphaned dependents that block this freeze among the 40 remaining open — two stale dependency lines are recorded in Decision §6 with their non-blocking rationale and a follow-up edit issues and no partial implementation anywhere in the 18. If that changes later — someone starts a branch against one of these before the tracker catches up — this ADR's "never-started" claim for that issue becomes stale and should be corrected via a reopen, not by rewriting this record.

Signed: thomas2025 · 2026-08-05T04:19:33-04:00